they generate. A lot of these people are just middle-class guys who want to go home to their wives and talk about schools for their kids, and suddenly they're coming to work and it's surveillance and court cases, and the majority just don't have the character for that. But the Iraq material was tremendously important, and I had a fight on, especially after the Swedish sex allegations, in keeping the partners to their agreements and their honour. There were signs. WikiLeaks began organising a joint press conference to announce the leaks. The Bureau of Investigative Journalism, who were also going creepy, were to be involved along with an organisation called Iraq Body Count and various others, including the media partners. The bell tolled, somewhere in my head – betrayal often comes not as a surprise but as a recognition – when the senior news reporter contact at the *Guardian* told my assistant, Sarah Harrison, that the paper did not want to be referred to as a media partner. He said he didn't want the *Guardian*'s logo on the banner behind us, and that he would be there, in the audience, as a reporter only.

Ding dong. Here he comes, holding his ears and claiming he only climbed into the cathedral's belltower so as to get a better view of the man in the street. He told us the *New York Times* and *Der Spiegel* felt the same way: no logos. We rented the Riverbank Hotel down near Vauxhall Bridge, in London, and we had hundreds of press people there. I brought Daniel Ellsberg over from the States to join me on the dais and we released the data and did a great number of interviews afterwards. Despite many irritations that would only really flare up later on, such as with the media partners and various exploiters, we had set about the release of the Iraq documents with as much precision as WikiLeaks could muster. It was important that we attached an NGO to the release, and Iraq Body Count were right on the nose, ethically speaking, keeping an impressively thorough record of civilian casualties since early in that war. They helped us to create an automatic redactions system for the 400,000 documents. It was also right to bring in *Le Monde*, as we did, as the French had rejected the war in 2003 and suffered as a result. The Spanish daily newspaper *El País* came on board, too. We worked with the Bureau of Investigative Journalism in London to produce documentaries on the diaries for Channel 4 and Al Jazeera. We, and our partners, had a sense that the data would augment (and add detail to) the public's perception that the war in Iraq was a failure and a threat to openness. American troops had already started to leave Iraq, while